New Delhi – legal scrubbing for these agreements were finalized in February, 2013. The agreement will be signed during ASEAN Economic Ministers (AEM)-India Consultations in *August 2013*.

RCEP

During the 20th ASEAN Summit held in Cambodia in April 2012, ASEAN States agreed to move towards establishing an RCEP (Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership) Agreement among *ASEAN + 6* (Australia, China, India, Japan, Korea, and New Zealand involving ASEAN and its FTA partners. The *objective* of launching RCEP negotiations is to achieve a modern, comprehensive, high-quality, and mutually beneficial economic partnership agreement among the ASEAN member States and ASEAN's FTA partners. The RCEP will *cover* trade in goods, trade in services, investment, economic and technical cooperation, intellectual property, competition, dispute settlement, and other issues.

BITA

Fifteen rounds of negotiations and a number of inter-sessional and Chief Negotiator level meetings of BITA (India - EU Broad Based Trade and Investment Agreement) have been held till date. The 15th round was held during December 4–7, 2012 in New Delhi. Chief negotiator level meeting was held on *January 29–30, 2013* in New Delhi.

GSTP

The agreement establishing the GSTP (Global System of Trade Preferences) among developing countries was signed on April 13, 1988 at Belgrade following the conclusion of the First Round of Negotiations. Forty-three countries have ratified the agreement and become participants. India has offered tariff concessions on 70.08 per cent of dutiable tariff lines with an across-the-board *margin of preference* (MoP) of 20 per cent on the applied tariffs prevailing on the date of import. India has also unilaterally offered special concessions to LDC participants by granting an MoP of 25 per cent on 77 per cent of all its dutiable tariff lines. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), in its meeting on August 23, 2012, has granted